

Malhar Gudekar

(217) -766-0681 — gudekar2@illinois.edu — LinkedIn — Portfolio — GitHub

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

August 2024 - May 2026

Master of Science, Information Management

GPA: 3.8/4

• Coursework: Web Programming, Machine Learning & Cloud, Information Management, Information Consulting, Methods of Data Science

University of Mumbai

June 2019 - May 2023

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Science

GPA: 9.25/10

• Coursework: Data Structures & Algorithms, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Object-Oriented Programming, Machine Learning, NLP

SKILLS

• **Languages & DSA:** Python, SQL, Data Structures & Algorithms (Arrays, Hashing, Trees, Graphs, Dynamic Programming), LeetCode

• **Backend & Systems:** FastAPI, REST APIs, Microservices, Distributed Systems, ETL Pipelines, Kafka, PySpark

• **Databases, Cloud & Tools:** PostgreSQL, Neo4j, AWS (S3, EC2, EKS), GCP, Docker, Git

WORK EXPERIENCE

Business Intelligence Group

August 2025 - December 2025

Technical Consultant

Champaign, USA

- Built and deployed production RAG and agentic AI systems using FastAPI, PostgreSQL, and vector embeddings, designing multi-step prompt chains and configuring LLM assistants for end-user-facing AI applications
- Designed efficient, fault-tolerant **ETL and async pipelines** to process and index large document datasets for low-latency retrieval systems
- Improved AI system performance by 64% through structured model evaluation, prompt optimization, and pipeline-level tuning, delivering evidence-based recommendations for production deployment decisions
- Developed backend services enabling real-time, high-performance **AI model serving** of unstructured data across distributed systems

University of Illinois Urbana Champaign

May 2025 - Present

Research Assistant - iSchool

Champaign, USA

- Owned end-to-end design, development, and integration of AI backend system ingesting multi-source data for 100+ users, normalizing and serving clean data to internal AI tools and downstream analytics pipelines
- Designed and optimized **PostgreSQL schema, indexing strategies, and distributed query execution plans** for high-volume datasets, improving query performance by 38% in production workloads
- Built production-ready Python LLM pipeline with retrieval, context summarization, and automated workflow integration, improving response accuracy by 43% and reducing manual processing steps
- Developed **asynchronous backend workflows** for real-time, fault-tolerant processing of longitudinal health data with focus on scalability

Research Assistant - CHI AI in Infodemic Management

January 2025 - May 2025

- Designed and deployed highly **scalable NLP and generative AI pipelines** in **Python** to process datasets, reducing processing latency by **41%**
- Built distributed data ingestion pipelines using **Kafka** and **Neo4j** Streams for real-time, high-throughput processing
- Designed and developed production-grade REST APIs using FastAPI to serve AI models, implementing prompt engineering workflows, security-aware data handling, monitoring, and deployment automation across distributed systems
- Enabled large-scale data processing across social media streams using **distributed systems and large-scale processing** principles

Swift Mobil Software Solutions Provider

July 2023 - October 2023

Data Analyst

Mumbai, IN

- Built interactive **Power BI** dashboards for **logistics** and **mobility KPIs**, reducing reporting time by **40%** and improving operational visibility
- Processed and optimized large-scale datasets using **Python** and **PySpark** to identify failure patterns and performance issues in distributed systems
- Developed **SQL** and **graph queries** to map dependencies, analyze operations, detect data issues, speeding root-cause analysis by **26%**

Pscope Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

January 2023 - June 2023

Data Analyst

Mumbai, IN

- Developed and maintained **20+ Power BI** dashboards across Sales, Finance, and Operations for enterprise clients, leveraging **SQL** and **DAX**, enabling KPI tracking and data-driven decisions
- Automated recurring **Excel**-based workflows using **VBA**, implementing validation and scheduling logic, reducing report preparation time by **42%** and improving consistency

Stu/Dio at Illinois

August 2025 - Present

Project Manager

Champaign, USA

- Led cross-functional team of 6 to scope and prioritize AI-driven product features, translating business requirements from non-technical stakeholders into technical solutions and iterating based on performance insights
- Tracked **sprint** progress, delivery metrics, and **QA issues** through **JIRA**-based workflows, managing backlog and issue resolution to ensure on-time delivery

PROJECTS

Scalable ML System for Customer Risk Prediction

March 2025

UIUC Hackathon

- Built an **end-to-end machine learning system** using Python, Pandas, and LightGBM to forecast customer spending and assess credit risk from large-scale **time-series** transaction data, including data preprocessing, feature engineering, model training, and evaluation
- Designed and implemented **scalable ETL and feature engineering pipelines**, capturing behavioral trends and temporal patterns such as rolling averages and spending frequency to improve model performance
- Developed a **decision framework for credit line adjustments**, incorporating model outputs and risk thresholds to improve prediction precision

by 20% and enable risk-aware classification of customers